

TOPIC 7: GROUP / COMBINED EVENTS (PART 1)

1. Classification of Combined Events

Combined events are competitions in which an athlete takes part in several track and field disciplines, with scores added to decide the overall winner. They test all-round ability rather than a single skill.

2. Examples of Combined Events

- **Decathlon** (usually men) – ten events over two days (e.g. sprints, hurdles, jumps, throws, distance).
- **Heptathlon** (usually women) – seven events over two days.
- Other multi-event formats exist at school and youth level with fewer events.

3. Duration

Major combined events are typically spread over two days to allow recovery between disciplines. Order of events is fixed by the rules so that no one event unfairly dominates preparation.

4. Summary

Combined events classify athletes by overall performance across several disciplines. Decathlon and heptathlon are the best-known examples.

End of Topic 7